Persist Week of September 21, 2026

REMINDER: Persist is no longer accessible through ATOM. To continue using Persist, you must log in through our new app. If you have not received your login instructions or are experiencing any issues, please contact us at support@functional-bodybuilding.com. We will continue to send a PDF version of training in our Persist only weekly newsletters.
This document may be created in advance of edits to the ongoing tracks in Persist, so while we try to minimize these discrepancies as much as possible, the version displayed in our app is always the most up to date. As always, please reach out using the chat bubble in our FBB app or on our website at https://functional-bodybuilding.com if you have any questions about the programming. It may be helpful to look over the week ahead to make sure your questions are all answered in time for your workout.

Pump Lift 5x
- Monday, September 21st, 2026
- Tuesday, September 22nd, 2026
- Wednesday, September 23rd, 2026
- Thursday, September 24th, 2026
- Friday, September 25th, 2026
- Saturday, September 26th, 2026
- Sunday, September 27th, 2026

Pump Lift 4x
- Monday, September 21st, 2026
- Tuesday, September 22nd, 2026
- Wednesday, September 23rd, 2026
- Thursday, September 24th, 2026
- Friday, September 25th, 2026
- Saturday, September 26th, 2026
- Sunday, September 27th, 2026

Pump Lift 3x
- Monday, September 21st, 2026
- Tuesday, September 22nd, 2026
- Wednesday, September 23rd, 2026
- Thursday, September 24th, 2026
- Friday, September 25th, 2026
- Saturday, September 26th, 2026
- Sunday, September 27th, 2026

- Pump Condition 5x
  - Monday, September 21st, 2026
  - Tuesday, September 22nd, 2026
  - Wednesday, September 23rd, 2026
  - Thursday, September 24th, 2026
  - Friday, September 25th, 2026
  - Saturday, September 26th, 2026
  - Sunday, September 27th, 2026
- Pump Condition 4x
  - Monday, September 21st, 2026
  - Tuesday, September 22nd, 2026
  - Wednesday, September 23rd, 2026
  - Thursday, September 24th, 2026
  - Friday, September 25th, 2026
  - Saturday, September 26th, 2026
  - Sunday, September 27th, 2026
- Pump Condition 3x
  - Monday, September 21st, 2026
  - Tuesday, September 22nd, 2026
  - Wednesday, September 23rd, 2026
  - Thursday, September 24th, 2026
  - Friday, September 25th, 2026
  - Saturday, September 26th, 2026
  - Sunday, September 27th, 2026
- Perform
  - Monday, September 21st, 2026
  - Tuesday, September 22nd, 2026
  - Wednesday, September 23rd, 2026
  - Thursday, September 24th, 2026
  - Friday, September 25th, 2026
  - Saturday, September 26th, 2026
  - Sunday, September 27th, 2026
- Minimalist
  - Monday, September 21st, 2026
  - Tuesday, September 22nd, 2026
  - Wednesday, September 23rd, 2026
  - Thursday, September 24th, 2026

Friday, September 25th, 2026
Saturday, September 26th, 2026
Sunday, September 27th, 2026

Pump Lift 5x

Monday, September 21st, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Pronated Pull Up + Supinated Pull Up
Back to the pronated pull up drop set with reps dropping to 6, paired again with the supinated pull up at the same load. The supinated grip recruits more biceps to assist the lat, which means you can push more reps after the pronated sets. Use your Week 3 working weights as a starting point and increase where you can.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Band or Cable Straight Arm Lat Pulldown; 10-15 reps
3. Seated DB Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets

1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Supinated Strict Pull Up or Supinated Lat Pulldown; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo @ same weight.
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note:
This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed. Use the same amount of assistance/load for the Supinated Strict Pull Up/Pulldown and perform as many reps as possible.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Dumbbell Pullover; 12-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 30-60 sec
2. Bent Over DB Reverse Fly; 12-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90sec
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Kelso Shrug; 20 reps
rest 30 sec
2. Dual KB Rack Carry; 100ft
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, September 22nd, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Seated Dumbbell Press Progression

Back to the seated dumbbell press with reps dropping to 6 across all working sets. The dumbbell version allows each arm to work independently along slightly different paths than the barbell, which reduces the risk of shoulder impingement under heavier loads. Use your Week 3 working weights as a starting point and increase where you can. The max unbroken drop set at the end finishes the session.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
3. PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles; 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Seated Dumbbell Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Push Up; 10-25 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. External Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 10-12 @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. The push up range is wide to accommodate different strength levels.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. 1 1/4 Barbell Curl; 12 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. Back Support Barbell Overhead Tricep Extension or Back Supported Cable Overhead Tricep Extension; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side
2. Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps

Wednesday, September 23rd, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
DB/KB Front Rack RFESS Progression
Back to the rear foot elevated split squat with the load in the front rack position and reps dropping to 6. The front rack keeps the torso more upright than a suitcase or goblet hold and increases the core demand to maintain position. Use your Week 3 working weights as a starting point and increase where you can. All sets are prescribed at RPE 8 to 10. Push hard on every set.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Shinbox Switch; 10 reps/side
3. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Cyclist Back Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
DB/KB Front Rack Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 10

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Suitcase Russian Step Up; 6-8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Forearm Plank Knee To Elbow; 30-45sec
rest 15-30 sec
2. Weighted Hanging Knee Tuck; 8-12 reps @20X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
The goal of this finisher is to build core strength. Keep quality high - you do not need to go to failure for a great stimulus in these muscles.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets
1. Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Thursday, September 24th, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40mins Total Work - Easy Effort
20mins Timer
Bike Easy - at mins 5, 10, 15, and 20 stop and perform
- 20sec Single Leg Wall Sit R
- 20sec Single Leg Wall Sit L
- 20sec Star Plank R
- 20sec Star Plank L
20mins Timer
Row Easy - at mins 5, 10, 15, and 20 stop and perform
- 20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric L
- 20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric R
- 20sec Single Arm Passive Hang L
- 20sec Single Arm Passive Hang R
*Move continuously at a steady pace for 40 minutes. Never exceed a pace that allows you to hold a comfortable conversation. You should not be breathing so heavily that you can't speak in complete sentences.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Pikes and Pancakes
Bodyweight RDL x 10
Elephant Walk Step x 10/side
Pike Stretch x 2 min
Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 2 min Center
Air Squat x 3-5 with 10 sec hold in bottom.

Friday, September 25th, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Barbell Bent Over Row
Back to the barbell bent over row with reps dropping to 10, 8, and 6 across the three working sets. Lower reps mean heavier weight on the back and posterior chain while holding the hinge position. Keep the torso angle consistent between sets and drive the elbows back rather than pulling with the hands. Use your Week 3 working weights as a starting point and increase where you can.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Forearm Plank to Dolphin Pose; 5-7 reps
3. Banded YTW; 6-8 reps in each position
4. Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (10-12 min):
Strict Bar Dip
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 2: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 3: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 5: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note:
This is a high density format. Select assistance consistent with about a 12 rep max dip.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Barbell Bent Over Row
Every 2:30 x 3 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. 1 1/4 Dumbbell Bench Press; 6 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec

2. Flat Bench DB Fly; 10-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Dumbbell Twist Curl; 15 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. Barbell Skullcrusher; 15 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
2. PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
3. Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side
4. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, September 26th, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
1 1/4 Goblet Cyclist Squat Progression
Back to the 1 1/4 goblet cyclist squat with reps dropping to 6 across all working sets. The quarter rep at the bottom continues to double the time under tension in the deepest and most demanding position. With fewer reps, the load goes up. Use your Week 3 working weights as a starting point and increase where you can. The max unbroken drop set at the end finishes the session at Set 1 weight.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
3. Lower Switch Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Front Rack Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
1 1/4 Goblet Cyclist Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
2-3 sets
1. Single Leg Bodyweight Hip Thrust; 6-10 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Ring, Slider, or Rower Body Saw; 30-45 sec
rest 30 sec
2. Donkey Calf Raise; 8-10 reps @32X1 Tempo
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30 sec

2. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
3. Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec

Sunday, September 27th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

Training Myth: You've already hit your peak

I want to talk to anyone who feels like they've already hit their peak. Maybe you're in your late thirties or forties and you've made peace with the idea that your best lifts are behind you. I'd challenge that. Most people never come close to their actual potential, at any age. What changes as we get older isn't your ceiling, it's usually your consistency, your recovery habits, or how intentional your training is. I've watched clients hit lifetime PRs in their forties and fifties, not because age doesn't matter, but because they finally trained with the structure and patience they never had in their twenties. Don't let a number on a birthday convince you the door is closed. It might just be that you haven't found the right way in yet.

Warmly, Marcus

Pump Lift 4x

Monday, September 21st, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Seated Dumbbell Press
Back to the seated dumbbell press with reps dropping to 6 across all working sets. The dumbbell version allows each arm to work independently along slightly different paths than the barbell, which reduces the risk of shoulder impingement under heavier loads. Use your Week 3 working weights as a starting point and increase where you can. The max unbroken drop set at the end finishes the session.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds

1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
3. PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles; 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (10 min):
Seated Dumbbell Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Push Up; 10-25 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. External Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 10-12 @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. The push up range is wide to accommodate different strength levels.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Kelso Shrug; 20 reps
rest 30 sec
2. Dual KB Rack Carry; 100ft
rest 60 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side
2. Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps

Tuesday, September 22nd, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
DB/KB Front Rack RFESS
Back to the rear foot elevated split squat with the load in the front rack position and reps dropping to 6. The front rack keeps the torso more upright than a suitcase or goblet hold and increases the core demand to maintain position. Use your Week 3 working weights as a starting point and increase where you can. All sets are prescribed at RPE 8 to 10. Push to failure on that last set. Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Shinbox Switch; 10 reps/side
3. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
1 1/4 Cyclist Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):

DB/KB Front Rack Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 10

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Suitcase Russian Step Up; 6-8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Forearm Plank Knee To Elbow; 30-45sec
rest 15-30 sec
2. Weighted Hanging Knee Tuck; 8-12 reps @20X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
The goal of this finisher is to build core strength. Keep quality high - you do not need to go to failure for a great stimulus in these muscles.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Wednesday, September 23rd, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min

walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Pikes and Pancakes
Bodyweight RDL x 10
Elephant Walk Step x 10/side
Pike Stretch x 2 min
Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 2 min Center
Air Squat x 3-5 with 10 sec hold in bottom.

Thursday, September 24th, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Pronated Pull Up + Supinated Pull Up
Back to the pronated pull up drop set with reps dropping to 6, paired again with the supinated pull up at the same load. The supinated grip recruits more biceps to assist the lat, which means you can push more reps after the pronated sets. Use your Week 3 working weights as a starting point and increase where you can.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Forearm Plank to Dolphin Pose; 5-7 reps
3. Banded YTW; 6-8 reps in each position
4. Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (10-12 min):
Strict Bar Dip
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 2: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 3: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 5: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note:

This is a high density format. Select assistance consistent with about a 12 rep max dip.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Supinated Strict Pull Up or Supinated Lat Pulldown; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo @ same weight.
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note:
This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed. Use the same amount of assistance/load for the Supinated Strict Pull Up/Pulldown and perform as many reps as possible.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. 1 1/4 Dumbbell Bench Press; 6 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Flat Bench DB Fly; 10-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Dumbbell Twist Curl; 15 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. Barbell Skullcrusher; 15 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
2. PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
3. Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side
4. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday, September 25th, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Front Rack Split Squat
Back to the front rack split squat with reps dropping to 6, so the weight goes up. Holding the load up front makes your core and upper back work hard to keep you upright. Keep your front heel flat and push through it every rep. Start with your Week 3 weights and add from there.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
3. Lower Switch Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Front Rack Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
2-3 sets
1. Single Leg Bodyweight Hip Thrust; 6-10 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec

2. Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Ring, Slider, or Rower Body Saw; 30-45 sec
rest 30 sec
2. Donkey Calf Raise; 8-10 reps @32X1 Tempo
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown:
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30 sec
2. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
3. Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec

Saturday, September 26th, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row 90sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x5
2 Sets
Dual KB Gunslinger x 8
Dual KB Clean x 8
Alternating KB Press x 4/arm
*Keep the KB Loads Very Light
Run/Bike/Row 90sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x5

2 Sets
10 KB Horn Bicep Curls
10 Alternating KB Clean to Rotational Press
10 Hollow Rocks

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Front Splits
1. Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
2. Active Straight Leg Raise x 5/side with 5 sec hold.
3. Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
4. Front Split Progression x 10/side
5. Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Sunday, September 27th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

Training Myth: You've already hit your peak

I want to talk to anyone who feels like they've already hit their peak. Maybe you're in your late thirties or forties and you've made peace with the idea that your best lifts are behind you. I'd challenge that. Most people never come close to their actual potential, at any age. What changes as we get older isn't your ceiling, it's usually your consistency, your recovery habits, or how intentional your training is. I've watched clients hit lifetime PRs in their forties and fifties, not because age doesn't matter, but because they finally trained with the structure and patience they never had in their twenties. Don't let a number on a birthday convince you the door is closed. It might just be that you haven't found the right way in yet.

Warmly, Marcus

Pump Lift 3x

Monday, September 21st, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Pronated Pull Up + Supinated Pull Up
Same drop set structure as the earlier weeks, but reps drop to 6, so the weight goes up. The pronated pull up comes first, then you move to the supinated grip with your palms facing you, which brings the biceps in to help the lats so you can squeeze out a few more reps once the pronated pull is fatigued. Start with your Week 3 weights and add from there.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Shinbox Switch; 10 reps/side
3. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
1 1/4 Cyclist Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Supinated Strict Pull Up or Supinated Lat Pulldown; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo @ same weight.
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note:
This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed. Use the same amount of assistance/load for the Supinated Strict Pull Up/Pulldown and perform as many reps as possible.

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets
1. Push Up; 10-25 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. External Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. The push up range is wide to accommodate different strength levels.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Kelso Shrug; 20 reps
rest 30 sec
2. Dual KB Rack Carry; 100ft
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side
2. Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps
3. Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 60 sec/side

Tuesday, September 22nd, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30 min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30 min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Mobility
Shoulder Circles x 5/side
Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1 min
Shoulder Extension Bridge x 5 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold
Prayer Stretch x 2 min
Prone Y Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold

Shoulder Circles (or shoulder wall circles) x 5/side
Passive Hang x 1 min

Wednesday, September 23rd, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
DB/KB Front Rack Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat
Back to the rear foot elevated split squat, now with the load in the front rack position and reps dropping to 6. The front rack keeps the torso more upright than a suitcase or goblet hold and increases the demand on the core and upper back to hold position. All sets are prescribed at RPE 8 to 10. Use your Week 3 working weights as a starting point and add where you can.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Bodyweight Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
3. PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles; 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
DB/KB Front Rack Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 10

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Head Support Bent Over DB Row; 12 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Bent Over DB Reverse Fly; 12-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Dumbbell Twist Curl; 15 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. Barbell Skullcrusher; 15 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Passive Hang; 30 sec
2. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Thursday, September 24th, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30 min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30 min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Squat Mobility
1. Shinbox Switch x 10/side
2. Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5/side
3. Shinbox Rear Leg ER + Shinbox Heel Touch x 5 reps/side
4. Downdog Calf Stretch x 10/leg
5. Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1-2 min/side
6. Frog Stretch x 1-2 min

7. Active Hip Flexion x 5/side with 5 sec hold
8. Russian Babymaker x 10
9. Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5/side
10. Squat Hip Rotations x 10/side

Friday, September 25th, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Seated Dumbbell Press
Back to the seated dumbbell press with reps dropping to 6 across the working sets. The dumbbell version lets each arm work independently along slightly different paths than the barbell, which reduces the risk of shoulder impingement at heavier loads. The set finishes with a max unbroken drop set at Set 1 weight. Use your Week 3 working weights as a starting point and increase where you can.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Band or Cable Straight Arm Lat Pulldown; 10-15 reps
3. Seated DB Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (10 min):
Seated Dumbbell Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Suitcase Russian Step Up; 6-8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Forearm Plank Knee To Elbow; 30-45 sec
rest 15-30 sec
2. Weighted Hanging Knee Tuck; 8-12 reps
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
The goal of this finisher is to build core strength. Keep quality high - you do not need to go to failure for a great stimulus in these muscles.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, September 26th, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row 90sec @ 75% effort

Rest 30sec
x5
2 Sets
Dual KB Gunslinger x 8
Dual KB Clean x 8
Alternating KB Press x 4/arm
*Keep the KB Loads Very Light
Run/Bike/Row 90sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x5
2 Sets
10 KB Horn Bicep Curls
10 Alternating KB Clean to Rotational Press
10 Hollow Rocks

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Front Splits
1. Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
2. Active Straight Leg Raise x 5/side with 5 sec hold.
3. Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
4. Front Split Progression x 10/side
5. Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Sunday, September 27th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

Training Myth: You've already hit your peak

I want to talk to anyone who feels like they've already hit their peak. Maybe you're in your late thirties or forties and you've made peace with the idea that your best lifts are behind you. I'd challenge that. Most people never come close to their actual potential, at any age. What changes as we get older isn't your ceiling, it's usually your consistency, your recovery habits, or how intentional your training is. I've watched clients hit lifetime PRs in their forties and fifties, not because age doesn't matter, but because they finally trained with the structure and patience they never had in their twenties. Don't let a number on a birthday convince you the door is closed. It might just be that you haven't found the right way in yet.

Warmly, Marcus

Pump Condition 5x

Monday, September 21st, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Pronated Pull Up + Supinated Pull Up
Back to the pronated pull up drop set with reps dropping to 6, paired again with the supinated pull up at the same load. The supinated grip recruits more biceps to assist the lat, which means you can push more reps after the pronated sets. Use your Week 3 working weights as a starting point and increase where you can.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Band or Cable Straight Arm Lat Pulldown; 10-15 reps
3. Seated DB Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Supinated Strict Pull Up or Supinated Lat Pulldown; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo @ same weight.

rest 2 minutes

Loading Note:

This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed. Use the same amount of assistance/load for the Supinated Strict Pull Up/Pulldown and perform as many reps as possible.

E) Hinge, Back, Bicep (15 min):
3 Sets
200ft Crush Grip Dumbbell Bicep Curl Carry
rest 15sec
10 Dumbbell Pendlay Row
rest 15sec
8 Dumbbell Hang Power Clean
rest 45-60sec between sets
*Begin with a light weight of around 20-30lb and increase with each set if you are feeling good.
Effort Note:
Short rests are intentionally included to allow for high quality on each movement. This is an extension of the Strength Balance section with a higher heart rate.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, September 22nd, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Seated Strict Press
The seated strict press takes your legs out of it, letting your shoulders do all the work overhead. Sitting also stops your lower back from helping. Keep the bar path straight up and brace your core on every rep. Pair it with push ups, which will feel harder than usual since your shoulders are already tired.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice

2. Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
3. PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles; 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Seated Strict Press; 6 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Push Up; 10-25 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. The push up range is wide to accommodate different strength levels.

E) Isometric Fatigue Shoulders (12 min):
Every 4mins x 3 Sets
5 Devils Press 50/35# (Male/Female)
30 sec Single Arm Front Rack Hold Right Arm 50/35#
30 sec Single Arm Front Rack Hold Left Arm 50/35#
15 Tall Kneeling DB Overhead Tricep Extension 35/25# (Male/Female)
15 Plank Press Up
Effort Note:
Isometrics are heavily underrated in most training programs. In this section, continuous movement keeps heart rate high, and isometrics build strength without sacrificing quality or your joints. Aim for a consistent pace with about 60 sec rest between sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side

2. Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps

Wednesday, September 23rd, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Goblet Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat
The goblet rear foot elevated split squat puts your back foot up on a bench so almost all the work lands on your front leg. Holding the weight at your chest keeps you tall and drives the load into that front quad. Go slow and keep the front heel down. Pair it with the Copenhagen plank to build the inner thigh, a spot that usually gets ignored.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Shinbox Switch; 10 reps/side
3. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Cyclist Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Goblet Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat; 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Fatigued Abdominals (15 min):
For Time
12 Weighted Hanging Knee Tuck (30/20#) (Male/Female) or Bodyweight Hanging Knee Tuck
12/9 Calorie Bike
12 Skater Jumps (6/side)
rest 30sec
18 Weighted Hanging Knee Tuck (30/20#) or Bodyweight Hanging Knee Tuck
18/14 Calorie Bike
18 Skater Jumps (9/side)
rest 30sec
24 Weighted Hanging Knee Tuck (30/20#) or Bodyweight Hanging Knee Tuck
24/18 Calorie Bike
24 Skater Jumps (12/side)
rest 30sec
30 Weighted Hanging Knee Tuck (30/20#) or Bodyweight Hanging Knee Tuck
30/24 Calorie Bike
30 Skater Jumps (15/side)
*15min Time Cap Including Rest Periods
Effort Note:
This workout is broken down into small, digestible sections. Put good effort into each one, but pace with intention from the beginning.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Thursday, September 24th, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40mins Total Work - Easy Effort
20mins Timer
Bike Easy - at mins 5, 10, 15, and 20 stop and perform

- 20sec Single Leg Wall Sit R
- 20sec Single Leg Wall Sit L
- 20sec Star Plank R
- 20sec Star Plank L

20mins Timer
Row Easy - at mins 5, 10, 15, and 20 stop and perform
- 20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric L
- 20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric R
- 20sec Single Arm Passive Hang L
- 20sec Single Arm Passive Hang R

*Move continuously at a steady pace for 40 minutes. Never exceed a pace that allows you to hold a comfortable conversation. You should not be breathing so heavily that you can't speak in complete sentences.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Pikes and Pancakes
Bodyweight RDL x 10
Elephant Walk Step x 10/side
Pike Stretch x 2 min
Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 2 min Center
Air Squat x 3-5 with 10 sec hold in bottom.

Friday, September 25th, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
1 1/4 Dumbbell Bench Press
The 1 1/4 dumbbell bench press adds a quarter rep at the bottom of each press, so you lower all the way, come up a quarter, back down, then press up fully. That extra quarter doubles the time your chest spends in the hardest, most stretched position. The weight will feel light on its own, but the flys that follow make sure your chest still gets a strong burn. Keep both moves close to failure. Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Forearm Plank to Dolphin Pose; 5-7 reps
3. Banded YTW; 6-8 reps in each position
4. Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (10-12 min):
Strict Bar Dip
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 2: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 3: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 5: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note:
This is a high density format. Select assistance consistent with about a 12 rep max dip.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. 1 1/4 Dumbbell Bench Press; 6 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Flat Bench DB Fly; 10-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Aerobic Push Pull (12 min):
12min Continuous Clock
8-12 Narrow Grip Push Up
12-16 Alternating DB Snatch From Floor 50/35# or 35/20# (Male/Female)
Bike 500/400m
Effort Note:
Aim for a steady pace on all movements. Avoid hitting failure on the bodyweight and DB movements. Take short breaks as needed to keep rest minimal throughout.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
2. PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
3. Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side
4. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, September 26th, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Cyclist Front Squat
The cyclist front squat pairs raised heels with a front rack hold, and both shift the work almost entirely onto your quads. The front rack also engages your upper back and core to help you stay tall. Keep your elbows high. Follow it with the hamstring walkout to balance out the back of your legs.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
3. Lower Switch Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Front Rack Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
2-3 sets
1. Cyclist Front Squat; 6 reps @20X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Hamstring Walkout; 40-60 sec
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

E) Interval Weight Training (12 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
200-250m Row

8 Burpee Box Jump 24/20" (Male/Female)
16 Split Stance Alternating Single Arm Russian KBS (8/side)
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Aim to increase the pace on the row each set. The movements are lower skill, allowing for higher effort output per set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30 sec
2. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
3. Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec

Sunday, September 27th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

Training Myth: You've already hit your peak

I want to talk to anyone who feels like they've already hit their peak. Maybe you're in your late thirties or forties and you've made peace with the idea that your best lifts are behind you. I'd challenge that. Most people never come close to their actual potential, at any age. What changes as we get older isn't your ceiling, it's usually your consistency, your recovery habits, or how intentional your training is. I've watched clients hit lifetime PRs in their forties and fifties, not because age doesn't matter, but because they finally trained with the structure and patience they never had in their twenties. Don't let a number on a birthday convince you the door is closed. It might just be that you haven't found the right way in yet.

Warmly, Marcus

Pump Condition 4x

Monday, September 21st, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Coach Notes:

Seated Strict Press
The seated strict press takes your legs out of it and makes your shoulders do all the work overhead. Sitting also stops your lower back from helping, so the press is more honest. Keep the bar path straight up and brace your core on every rep. Pair it with push ups, which will feel harder than usual since your shoulders are already tired.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
3. PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles; 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Seated Strict Press; 6 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Push Up; 10-25 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. The push up range is wide to accommodate different strength levels.

E) Isometric Fatigue Shoulders (12 min):
Every 4mins x 3 Sets
5 Devils Press 50/35# (Male/Female)
30-sec Cross Body Carry Right Arm 50/35#
30-sec Cross Body Carry Left Arm 50/35#

15 Crush Grip Hammer Curls 50/35#
15 Plank Press Up
Effort Note:
Isometrics are heavily underrated in most training programs. In this section the continuous movement keeps the heart rate high, and the isometrics build strength without sacrificing quality or your joints in the process. Aim for a consistent pace with about 60 sec rest between sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side
2. Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps

Tuesday, September 22nd, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Coach Notes:
Goblet Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat
The goblet rear foot elevated split squat puts your back foot up on a bench so almost all the work lands on your front leg. Holding the weight at your chest keeps you tall and drives the load into that front quad. Go slow and keep the front heel down. Pair it with the Copenhagen plank to build the inner thigh, a spot that usually gets ignored.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Shinbox Switch; 10 reps/side
3. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Cyclist Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Goblet Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat; 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Fatigued Abdominals (15 min):
For Time
12 Weighted Hanging Knee Tuck (30/20#) (Male/Female) or Bodyweight Hanging Knee Tuck
12/9 Calorie Bike
12 Skater Jumps (6/side)
rest 30 sec
18 Weighted Hanging Knee Tuck (30/20#) or Bodyweight Hanging Knee Tuck
18/14 Calorie Bike
18 Skater Jumps (9/side)
rest 30 sec
24 Weighted Hanging Knee Tuck (30/20#) or Bodyweight Hanging Knee Tuck
24/18 Calorie Bike
24 Skater Jumps (12/side)
rest 30 sec
30 Weighted Hanging Knee Tuck (30/20#) or Bodyweight Hanging Knee Tuck
30/24 Calorie Bike
30 Skater Jumps (15/side)
*15 min Time Cap Including Rest Periods
Effort Note:
This workout is broken down into small digestible sections. Put good effort into each one, but pace with intention from the beginning.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side

2. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Wednesday, September 23rd, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30 min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30 min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Pikes and Pancakes
Bodyweight RDL x 10
Elephant Walk Step x 10/side
Pike Stretch x 2 min
Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 2 min Center
Air Squat x 3-5 with 10 sec hold in bottom.

Thursday, September 24th, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Coach Notes:
Pronated Pull Up + Supinated Pull Up
Same super set as the earlier weeks, but reps drop to 6, so the load goes up. Start with the pronated pull up, palms facing away, then after a short rest switch to a supinated pull up with your palms facing you. That underhand grip brings the biceps in to help, so you can squeeze out a few more reps once the pronated pull is fatigued. Start from your Week 3 weights and add where you can.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Forearm Plank to Dolphin Pose; 5-7 reps
3. Banded YTW; 6-8 reps in each position
4. Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (10-12 min):

Strict Bar Dip
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 2: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 3: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 5: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note:
This is a high density format. Select assistance consistent with about a 12 rep max dip.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Supinated Strict Pull Up or Supinated Lat Pulldown; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo @ same weight.
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note:
This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pull down using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed. Use the same amount of assistance/load for the Supinated Strict Pull Up/Pulldown and perform as many reps as possible.

E) Aerobic Push Pull (12 min):
12min Continuous Clock
8-12 Narrow Grip Push Up
12-16 Alternating DB Snatch From Floor 50/35# or 35/20# (Male/Female)
Bike 500/400m
Effort Note:
Aim for a steady pace on all movements. Avoid hitting failure on the bodyweight and DB movements. Take short breaks as needed to keep rest minimal throughout.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
2. PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
3. Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side
4. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday, September 25th, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Coach Notes:
Front Rack Split Squat
The last front rack split squat of the cycle, and reps climb to twelve per side this week, so this is the highest volume of the block. Holding the load in the front rack makes your core and upper back work hard to keep you tall while the split stance trains one leg at a time. Keep your front heel flat and drive through it on every rep. Follow it with the hamstring walkout to balance out the back of your legs.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
3. Lower Switch Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
2-3 sets
1. Front Rack Split Squat; 12 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Hamstring Walkout; 40-60 sec
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

E) Interval Weight Training (12 min):

3 Sets @ high effort
200-250m Row
8 Burpee Box Jump 24/20" (Male/Female)
16 Split Stance Alternating Single Arm Russian KB Swings (8/side)
rest 90 sec between sets
Effort Note:
Aim to increase the pace on the row each set. The movements are lower skill, allowing for higher effort output for each set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30 sec
2. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
3. Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec

Saturday, September 26th, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row 90sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x5
2 Sets
Dual KB Gunslinger x 8
Dual KB Clean x 8
Alternating KB Press x 4/arm
*Keep the KB Loads Very Light
Run/Bike/Row 90sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x5
2 Sets
10 KB Horn Bicep Curls
10 Alternating KB Clean to Rotational Press
10 Hollow Rocks

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Front Splits
1. Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
2. Active Straight Leg Raise x 5/side with 5 sec hold.
3. Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
4. Front Split Progression x 10/side
5. Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Sunday, September 27th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

Training Myth: You've already hit your peak

I want to talk to anyone who feels like they've already hit their peak. Maybe you're in your late thirties or forties and you've made peace with the idea that your best lifts are behind you. I'd challenge that. Most people never come close to their actual potential, at any age. What changes as we get older isn't your ceiling, it's usually your consistency, your recovery habits, or how intentional your training is. I've watched clients hit lifetime PRs in their forties and fifties, not because age doesn't matter, but because they finally trained with the structure and patience they never had in their twenties. Don't let a number on a birthday convince you the door is closed. It might just be that you haven't found the right way in yet.

Warmly, Marcus

Pump Condition 3x

Monday, September 21st, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Coach Notes:
Pronated Pull Up + Supinated Pull Up
Same superset as the earlier weeks, but reps drop to 6 so you can add load. The second move is the supinated pull up, palms facing you, which brings your biceps in to squeeze out a few more reps once the pronated pull is fatigued. Match your assistance across both movements and push the supinated set to as many quality reps as possible.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Shinbox Switch; 10 reps/side
3. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Cyclist Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Supinated Strict Pull Up or Supinated Lat Pulldown; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo @ same weight.
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note:
This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed. Use the same amount of assistance/load for the Supinated Strict Pull Up/Pulldown and perform as many reps as possible.

E) Aerobic Push Pull (12 min):
12min Continuous Clock
8-12 Narrow Grip Push Up
12-16 Alternating Dumbbell Snatch From Floor 50/35# or 35/20#
Bike 500/400m (Male/Female)
Effort Note:
Aim for a steady pace on all movements. Avoid hitting failure on the bodyweight and DB

movements. Take short breaks as needed to keep rest minimal throughout.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side
2. Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps
3. Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 60 sec/side

Tuesday, September 22nd, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Mobility
Shoulder Circles x5/side
Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1 min
Shoulder Extension Bridge x 5 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold
Prayer Stretch x 2 min
Prone Y Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold
Shoulder Circles (or shoulder wall circles) x 5/side
Passive Hang x 1 min

Wednesday, September 23rd, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Coach Notes:
Goblet Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat
The goblet rear foot elevated split squat puts your back foot up on a bench so almost all the work lands on your front leg. Holding the weight at your chest keeps you tall and drives the load into that front quad. Go slow and keep the front heel down. Pair it with the Copenhagen plank to build the inner thigh, a spot that usually gets ignored.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
3. PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles; 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Goblet Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat; 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
- rest 60 sec
2. Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Hinge, Back, Bicep (15 min):
3 Sets
200ft Crush Grip Dumbbell Bicep Curl Carry
rest 15sec
10 Dumbbell Pendlay Row
rest 15sec
8 Dumbbell Hang Power Clean
rest 45-60sec between sets
*Begin with a light weight of around 20-30lb and increase with each set if you are feeling good.
Effort Note:
Short rests are intentionally included to allow for high quality on each movement. This is an extension of the Strength Balance section with a higher heart rate.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Passive Hang; 30 sec
2. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Thursday, September 24th, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Squat Mobility
1. Shinbox Switch x 10/side
2. Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5/side
3. Shinbox Rear Leg ER + Shinbox Heel Touch x 5 reps/side
4. Downdog Calf Stretch x 10/leg
5. Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1-2 min/side
6. Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
7. Active Hip Flexion x 5/side with 5 sec hold
8. Russian Babymaker x 10
9. Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5/side
10. Squat Hip Rotations x 10/side

Friday, September 25th, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Coach Notes:
Seated Strict Press + Strict Bar Dip
This press and dip pairing hits your shoulders and triceps from two angles with a short rest between. The seated strict press takes your legs out of it so your shoulders do all the overhead work, and reps drop to 6 this week so you can press heavier. The strict bar dip that follows uses a slow 30X0 tempo — three seconds down — to load the bottom stretch. Keep both close to form failure.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Band or Cable Straight Arm Lat Pulldown; 10-15 reps
3. Seated Dumbbell Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Seated Strict Press; 6 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 30 sec
2. Strict Bar Dip; 8-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Interval Weight Training (12 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
200-250m Row
8 Burpee Box Jump 24/20" (Male/Female)
16 Split Stance Alternating Single Arm Russian KB Swings (8/side)
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Aim to increase the pace on the row each set. The movements are lower skill, allowing for higher effort output for each set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets

1. Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, September 26th, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row 90sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x5
2 Sets
Dual KB Gunslinger x 8
Dual KB Clean x 8
Alternating KB Press x 4/arm
*Keep the KB Loads Very Light
Run/Bike/Row 90sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x5
2 Sets
10 KB Horn Bicep Curls
10 Alternating KB Clean to Rotational Press
10 Hollow Rocks

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Front Splits
1. Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
2. Active Straight Leg Raise x 5/side with 5 sec hold.
3. Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
4. Front Split Progression x 10/side
5. Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Sunday, September 27th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

Training Myth: You've already hit your peak

I want to talk to anyone who feels like they've already hit their peak. Maybe you're in your late thirties or forties and you've made peace with the idea that your best lifts are behind you. I'd challenge that. Most people never come close to their actual potential, at any age. What changes as we get older isn't your ceiling, it's usually your consistency, your recovery habits, or how intentional your training is. I've watched clients hit lifetime PRs in their forties and fifties, not because age doesn't matter, but because they finally trained with the structure and patience they never had in their twenties. Don't let a number on a birthday convince you the door is closed. It might just be that you haven't found the right way in yet.

Warmly, Marcus

Perform

Monday, September 21st, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Full Snatch
Singles of the full snatch every ninety seconds across eight sets. The full snatch receives the bar in the bottom of an overhead squat, which demands speed under the bar and a confident catch in the deep position. Keep the bar close through the pull and pull yourself under aggressively. Sets 1 to 3 are easy, 4 to 6 moderate, and 7 to 8 challenging, so use the early sets to sharpen the turnover before the weight climbs.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Run Mix Modal based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Band or Cable Straight Arm Lat Pulldown; 10-15 reps
1. Seated DB Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Speed Strength - Snatch (15-18 min):

Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Snatch Grip Romanian Deadlift
10 BTN Snatch Press or BTN Snatch Push Press
10 Overhead Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Snatch Grip Hold
10 sec Snatch Grip Overhead Hold
10 sec Overhead Squat Hold
Every 90 sec x 8 sets
1 Full Snatch
rest until the next 90 sec
Sets 1-3: Easy
Sets 4-6: Moderate
Sets 7-8: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Supinated Strict Pull Up or Supinated Lat Pulldown; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo @ same weight
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note: This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed. Use the same amount of assistance/load for the Supinated Strict Pull Up/Pulldown and perform as many reps as possible.

F) Run Mix Modal (12 min):
12 min SUSTAINED PACE
4 Shuttle Run
6 Devils Press 50/35# (Male/Female)

8 Weighted Hanging Leg Tuck 35/20#
Effort Note: To maximize the total reps during the 12 minutes, perform at a sustainable pace. Start smooth; at about 4 minutes start to pick up the pace if you are feeling great.
*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, September 22nd, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Seated Strict Press + Push Up
This is a super set for the shoulders and chest. The seated strict press takes the legs out of it so the shoulders do all the overhead work, then you move straight into push ups while already fatigued. Keep the press strict with no leg drive and hold a tight body line on the push ups. Push both close to failure each round.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Upper Intervals based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
1. Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
1. PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles; 5-7 reps/side

C) HS HOT START (15 min):
Every 3 min x 5 Sets
5 Deficit Strict HSPU or Deficit Pike HSPU or Inchworm Push Up
7 Tuck Ups
Bike 18/15 Cals
7 Tuck Ups
5 Yoga Push Ups

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Seated Strict Press; 6 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Push Up; 10-25 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note: Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. The push up range is wide to accommodate different strength levels.

F) Upper Intervals (12 min):
Every 4 min x 3 Sets
5 KB Clean + Push Press Right
10 Burpee Over KB
5 KB Clean + Push Press Left
Run 200-300m
Effort Note: Control your breathing with the goal of each set being consistent or close to the previous set. Adjust run distance to have at least 45 seconds of rest remaining before the start of the next set.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side
1. Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps

Wednesday, September 23rd, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Power Clean
A power clean complex every two to three minutes across five sets. The power clean catches the bar above parallel, which demands a fast pull and an aggressive elbow turnover before the hips

fully open. This week pairs the clean with hang cleans and a box jump to train speed and force together. Sets 1 and 2 are easy, 3 and 4 moderate, and 5 challenging, so dial in the pull before adding weight.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Lower Sprint based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Shinbox Switch; 10 reps/side
1. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 10 reps/side

C) Speed Strength - Clean (15-18 min):
Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Romanian Deadlift
10 Strict Press
10 Front Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Clean Grip Hold
10 sec Front Rack Hold
10 sec Front Squat Hold
Every 2:00-3:00 x 5 sets
1 Power Clean + 2 Hang Clean + 3 Box Jump Step Down
rest until next 2:00
Sets 1-2: Easy
Sets 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Cyclist Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (10 min):

3 sets
1. Goblet Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat; 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Lower Sprint (10 min):
Every 2:30 x 5 sets
24 Weight Plate Russian Twists (12/side) 35/25# or 25/10#
30 Double Unders
20 sec Bike SPRINT
rest until the start of the next 2:30
Effort Note: Use the following guide to approach each set with escalating effort on the Bike.
Set 1 - Moderate Effort - RPE 7-8
Set 2 - Hard Effort - RPE 8-9
Sets 3-5 - Maximal Effort - RPE 9-10

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Thursday, September 24th, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PERFORM

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min Total Work - Easy Effort
20 min Timer:
Bike Easy - at mins 5, 10, 15, and 20 stop and perform:
- 20 sec Single Leg Wall Sit R
- 20 sec Single Leg Wall Sit L
- 20 sec Star Plank R
- 20 sec Star Plank L
20 min Timer:
Row Easy - at mins 5, 10, 15, and 20 stop and perform:

- 20 sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric L
- 20 sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric R
- 20 sec Single Arm Passive Hang L
- 20 sec Single Arm Passive Hang R

*Move continuously at a steady pace for 40 minutes. Never exceed a pace that allows you to hold a comfortable conversation.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Pikes and Pancakes
Bodyweight RDL x 10
Elephant Walk Step x 10/side
Pike Stretch x 2 min
Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 2 min Center
Air Squat x 3-5 with 10 sec hold in bottom

Friday, September 25th, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
1 1/4 Dumbbell Bench Press + Flat Bench DB Fly
This is a superset for the chest. The 1 1/4 dumbbell bench adds a quarter rep out of the bottom to pile up time in the hardest part of the press. Move into the flat bench fly to stretch the chest under a slow tempo and finish it off. Push both close to failure each set.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Aerobic Push Pull based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
1. Forearm Plank to Dolphin Pose; 5-7 reps
1. Banded YTW; 6-8 reps in each position
1. Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) KB HOT START (10 min):
3-4 sets
15/12 Cal Bike
4 Dual KB Clean
5 Dual KB Clean From Floor
6 Dual KB Rack Squat
rest 30 sec between sets

D) Strength Intensity (10-12 min):
Strict Bar Dip
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 2: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 3: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 5: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Loading Note: This is a high density format. Select assistance consistent with about a 12 rep max dip.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. 1 1/4 Dumbbell Bench Press; 6 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Flat Bench DB Fly; 10-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warm up sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Aerobic Push Pull (12 min):
12 min Continuous Clock
4-6 Ring Muscle Up
8-12 Narrow Grip Push Up
Bike 500/400m (Male/Female)
Effort Note: Aim for a steady pace on all movements. Take short breaks as needed to keep rest minimal throughout.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
1. PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
1. Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, September 26th, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Cyclist Front Squat + Hamstring Walkout
This is a super set for the quads and hamstrings. The cyclist front squat raises the heels and holds the bar in the front rack to drive the work into the quads through a tall, deep squat. Move into the hamstring walkout, walking the feet out and back to load the hamstrings under a long lever. Aim for RPE 8 to 9 across all sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Power 30 based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
1. Lower Switch Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Front Rack Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Cyclist Front Squat; 6 reps @20X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Hamstring Walkout; 40-60 sec
rest 90 sec
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

E) Power 30 (30 min):
Part 1 — For Time @ Tough Effort (7 min Cap)
15 Bar Facing Burpees
15 Hang Power Cleans 135/95# (Male/Female)
12 Bar Facing Burpees
12 Hang Power Cleans 135/95#
10 Bar Facing Burpees

10 Hang Power Cleans 135/95#

Effort Note: These Time Caps are intentionally challenging. Work hard to try and get your time under this number, but by no means get down if you don't. You will get a minimum of 3 minutes rest before part 2 regardless. The barbell weight should be something that you believe you can perform each set unbroken, but will be challenging to do so.

Part 2 — Beginning at 10 min on the clock, Every 5 min x 4 Sets:
12-16 Cal Row
12-16 GHD Sit Ups
12-16 Alternating DB Snatch (50/35#)
12-16 Box Jump Overs 30/24"
*rest the remainder of the time before the next 5 min period

Effort Note: Try to keep your times between 2:30-3:30 for each set. If you are taking longer then drop the reps. The DB weight should allow you to perform the first set unbroken with the expectation of breaking up a little more each round; adjust accordingly.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30 sec
1. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
1. Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec

Sunday, September 27th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PERFORM
Training Myth: You've already hit your peak
I want to talk to anyone who feels like they've already hit their peak. Maybe you're in your late thirties or forties and you've made peace with the idea that your best lifts are behind you. I'd challenge that. Most people never come close to their actual potential, at any age. What changes as we get older isn't your ceiling, it's usually your consistency, your recovery habits, or how intentional your training is. I've watched clients hit lifetime PRs in their forties and fifties, not because age doesn't matter, but because they finally trained with the structure and patience they never had in their twenties. Don't let a number on a birthday convince you the door is closed. It might just be that you haven't found the right way in yet.
Warmly, Marcus

Minimalist

Monday, September 21st, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Coach Notes:
Seated DB Press
The seated DB press takes your legs out of it and makes your shoulders do all the work overhead. Sitting also stops your lower back from helping, so the press is more honest. Keep the dumbbells traveling straight up and brace your core on every rep. Pair it with push ups, which will feel harder than usual since your shoulders are already tired.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
1. Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
1. PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles; 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
DB Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Seated DB Press; 6 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Push Up; 10-25 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. The push up range is wide to accommodate different strength levels.

E) Isometric Fatigue Shoulders (12 min):

Every 4mins x 3 Sets
5 Devils Press 50/35# (Male/Female)
30-sec Cross Body Carry Right Arm 50/35#
30-sec Cross Body Carry Left Arm 50/35#
15 Crush Grip Hammer Curls 50/35#
15 Plank Press Up
Effort Note: Isometrics are heavily underrated in most training programs. In this section, the continuous movement keeps the heart rate high, and the isometrics build strength without sacrificing quality or your joints in the process. Aim for a consistent pace with about 60 sec rest between sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side
1. Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps

Tuesday, September 22nd, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Coach Notes:
Goblet Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat
The goblet rear foot elevated split squat puts your back foot up on a bench so almost all the work lands on your front leg. Holding the weight at your chest keeps you tall and drives the load into that front quad. Go slow and keep the front heel down. Pair it with the Copenhagen plank to build the inner thigh, a spot that usually gets ignored.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Shinbox Switch; 10 reps/side
1. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Cyclist Goblet Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Goblet Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat; 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Fatigued Abdominals (15 min):
For Time
400m Run
12 Weighted Hanging Knee Tuck
12 Skater Jumps (6/side)
rest 30sec
300m Run
18 Weighted Hanging Knee Tuck
18 Skater Jumps (9/side)
rest 30sec
200m Run
24 Weighted Hanging Knee Tuck
24 Skater Jumps (12/side)
rest 30sec
100m Run
30 Weighted Hanging Knee Tuck
30 Skater Jumps (15/side)
*15min Time Cap Including Rest Periods
Effort Note: This workout is broken down into small digestible sections. Put good effort into each one, but pace with intention from the beginning.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side

1. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Wednesday, September 23rd, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Pikes and Pancakes
Bodyweight RDL x 10
Elephant Walk Step x 10/side
Pike Stretch x 2 min
Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 2 min Center
Air Squat x 3-5 with 10 sec hold in bottom.

Thursday, September 24th, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Coach Notes:
1 1/4 Dumbbell Bench Press
The 1 1/4 dumbbell bench press adds a quarter rep at the bottom of each press: lower all the way, come up a quarter, lower back down, then press up fully. That extra quarter doubles the time your chest spends in the hardest, most stretched position. The weight will feel light on its own, but the flys that follow make sure your chest still gets a strong burn. Keep both moves close to failure.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
1. Forearm Plank to Dolphin Pose; 5-7 reps
1. Banded YTW; 6-8 reps in each position
1. Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
3 sets

1. Pronated Strict Pull Up; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Supinated Strict Pull Up; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo @ same weight.
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note: This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed. Use the same amount of assistance/load for the Supinated Strict Pull Up/Pulldown and perform as many reps as possible.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. 1 1/4 Dumbbell Bench Press; 6 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Flat Bench DB Fly; 10-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Aerobic Push Pull (12 min):
12min Continuous Clock
8-12 Narrow Grip Push Up
12-16 Alternating DB Snatch From Floor 50/35# or 35/20# (Male/Female)
5 Shuttle Run
*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.
Effort Note: Aim for a steady pace on all movements. Avoid hitting failure on the bodyweight and DB movements. Take short breaks as needed to keep rest minimal throughout.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
1. PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
1. Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday, September 25th, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Coach Notes:
DB Front Rack Split Squat
The DB front rack split squat holds the dumbbells up at your shoulders, which forces your core and

upper back to work harder to stay tall than a goblet or suitcase hold would. The split stance loads one leg at a time, so keep your front heel flat and drive through it on every rep. Reps climb to twelve per side this week, so pick a load you can own for the full set. Finish with the hamstring walkout to balance out the back of your legs.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
1. Lower Switch Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
DB Sumo RDL
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
2-3 sets
1. DB Front Rack Split Squat; 12 reps/side @20X0
rest 60 sec
2. Hamstring Walkout; 40-60 sec
rest 90 sec
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

E) Interval Weight Training (12 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
200m Run
8 Burpee Box Jump
16 Dumbbell Swings
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note: Aim to increase the pace on the row each set. The movements are lower skill, allowing for higher effort output for each set.

F) Cooldown:
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30 sec
1. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
1. Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec

Saturday, September 26th, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row 90sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x5
2 Sets
Dual KB Gunslinger x 8
Dual KB Clean x 8
Alternating KB Press x 4/arm
*Keep the KB Loads Very Light
Run/Bike/Row 90sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x5
2 Sets
10 KB Horn Bicep Curls
10 Alternating KB Clean to Rotational Press
10 Hollow Rocks

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Front Splits
1. Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
1. Active Straight Leg Raise x 5/side with 5 sec hold.
1. Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
1. Front Split Progression x 10/side

1. Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Sunday, September 27th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist MINIMALIST

Training Myth: You've already hit your peak

I want to talk to anyone who feels like they've already hit their peak. Maybe you're in your late thirties or forties and you've made peace with the idea that your best lifts are behind you. I'd challenge that. Most people never come close to their actual potential, at any age. What changes as we get older isn't your ceiling, it's usually your consistency, your recovery habits, or how intentional your training is. I've watched clients hit lifetime PRs in their forties and fifties, not because age doesn't matter, but because they finally trained with the structure and patience they never had in their twenties. Don't let a number on a birthday convince you the door is closed. It might just be that you haven't found the right way in yet.

Warmly,
Marcus